



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



CVE-2026-48282 Adobe ColdFusion RDS Path Traversal Active Exploitation

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | CVE-2026-48282 Adobe ColdFusion RDS Path Traversal Active Exploitation - CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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1. Executive Summary

Lost Boys Cyber selected ****CVE-2026-48282 Adobe ColdFusion RDS Path Traversal Active Exploitation**** for the 2026-07-08 daily vulnerability-prioritization run. CISA added CVE-2026-48282 to KEV after active exploitation reporting. Public reporting describes an Adobe ColdFusion path traversal flaw that can lead to arbitrary code execution, with risk concentrated on internet-accessible or misconfigured ColdFusion systems where RDS is enabled.

Defenders should treat this as an immediate exposure-management item where affected technology is reachable from the internet or is present in high-trust internal service tiers. This report turns public reporting into a practical patch, detection, and hunting brief.

2. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Value
Severity	critical
Confidence	high
Current exploitation	Reported by CISA KEV or supporting public reporting
Primary exposure	Adobe ColdFusion servers, especially internet-facing deployments and developer/RDS-enabled instances.
Recommended action today	Patch ColdFusion, disable unauthenticated RDS exposure, inspect web roots for unexpected uploads, and hunt for crafted traversal requests and new web-accessible files.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	URL	Analyst Use
CISA KEV alert for CVE-2026-48282	https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/07/07/cisa-adds-one-known-exploited-vulnerability-catalog	Primary context used for this assessment.
Resecurity technical write-up	https://www.resecurity.com/blog/article/cve-2026-48282-adobe-coldfusion-rds-path-traversal-leading-to-rce	Supporting context used for this assessment.
Help Net Security exploitation coverage	https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/07/adobe-coldfusion-cve-2026-48282-exploitation-detected/	Supporting context used for this assessment.
Adobe patch context via SecurityWeek	https://www.securityweek.com/adobe-patches-critical-coldfusion-campaign-classic-vulnerabilities/	Supporting context used for this assessment.

At least three sources were used where available. Claims are constrained to public reporting and should be validated against asset inventory and vendor advisories before emergency changes.

4. Vulnerability Details

CISA added CVE-2026-48282 to KEV after active exploitation reporting. Public reporting describes an Adobe ColdFusion path traversal flaw that can lead to arbitrary code execution, with risk concentrated on internet-accessible or misconfigured ColdFusion systems where RDS is enabled. The most important operational question is whether affected systems are externally reachable, have sensitive trust relationships, or can be abused to stage web shells, agent workflows, credentials, or follow-on payloads.

5. Attack Scenarios

Scenario	Preconditions	Likely Follow-On
Opportunistic internet exploitation	Vulnerable service reachable from attacker infrastructure	Web shell, arbitrary code execution, credential theft, persistence
Targeted exploitation	Asset belongs to a high-value organization or supplier	Lateral movement, data staging, ransomware preparation
Post-patch residual compromise	Patch applied after exploitation	Hidden accounts, malicious files, tokens, or scheduled tasks remain

6. Affected Products and Exposure

Exposure Area	Why It Matters	Validation Step
Adobe ColdFusion servers, especially internet-facing deployments and developer/RDS-enabled instances.	Primary technology or deployment model described by reporting.	Query external ASM, CMDB, EDR inventory, and vulnerability scanners.
Identity and admin surfaces	Compromise often becomes severe when local or app credentials are captured.	Review new accounts, token creation, MFA changes, and admin logins.
Web roots / upload locations	RCE and file-upload flaws frequently leave artifacts on disk.	Compare recent file writes with known-good baselines.

7. Mitigation and Workarounds

Priority	Action	Owner
P0	Apply vendor fixes or remove vulnerable exposure.	Vulnerability Management / Platform Owner
P0	Hunt for exploitation before and after patch time.	SOC / Detection Engineering
P1	Rotate credentials and tokens if compromise indicators appear.	IAM / App Owner
P1	Add compensating WAF, ingress, and logging controls.	Network / Security Engineering

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
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Suspicious web-server child process	EDR process telemetry	Detect code execution after exploitation
New executable/script file in web-accessible directory	File telemetry	Detect web shell or payload upload
Requests containing traversal, upload, or suspicious endpoint patterns	Web/WAF logs	Identify exploit attempts
title: Lost Boys Cyber - CVE-2026-48282 Adobe ColdFusion RDS Path Traversal Active Exploitation id: lbc-cve-2026-48282-adobe-coldfusion-rds-path-traversal status: experimental description: Behavioral detection for exploitation follow-up associated with CVE-2026-48282 Adobe ColdFusion RDS Path Traversal Active Exploitation. logsource: - product: windows - category: process_creation detection: - selection_web_parent: - ParentImage contains: '\w3wp.exe' '\httpd.exe' '\nginx.exe' '\tomcat' - selection_shell: - Image endswith: '\cmd.exe' '\powershell.exe' '\bash.exe' condition: selection_web_parent and selection_shell fields: - UtcTime - Image - ParentImage - CommandLine falsepositives: - Rare administrative scripts launched by web services level: high		

9. Threat Hunting

<pre>DeviceProcessEvents where Timestamp > ago(14d) where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("w3wp.exe", "httpd.exe", "nginx.exe", "tomcat.exe", "java.exe") where FileName in~ ("cmd.exe", "powershell.exe", "bash.exe", "sh", "python.exe", "perl.exe") project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName</pre>
<pre>DeviceFileEvents where Timestamp > ago(14d) where FolderPath has_any ("wwwroot", "htdocs", "webapps", "plugins", "administrator") where ActionType in ("FileCreated", "FileModified") where FileName endswith ".php" or FileName endswith ".jsp" or FileName endswith ".cfm" or FileName endswith ".aspx" project Timestamp, DeviceName, FolderPath, FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine</pre>

10. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Rationale
T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application	Publicly reachable applications are the primary exposure.
T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter	Common post-exploitation execution path.
T1505.003 Web Shell	Plausible persistence when exploitation enables file upload or

	server-side execution.
T1078 Valid Accounts	Follow-on credential or token abuse risk.

11. Recommended Actions Summary

Timeframe	Action
Today	Patch ColdFusion, disable unauthenticated RDS exposure, inspect web roots for unexpected uploads, and hunt for crafted traversal requests and new web-accessible files.
24-72 hours	Complete compromise assessment for exposed systems.
7 days	Add detections to SIEM/EDR and validate alert routing.

12. References

- [1] CISA KEV alert for CVE-2026-48282: <https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/07/07/cisa-adds-one-known-exploited-vulnerability-catalog>
- [2] Resecurity technical write-up: <https://www.resecurity.com/blog/article/cve-2026-48282-adobe-coldfusion-rds-path-traversal-leading-to-rce>
- [3] Help Net Security exploitation coverage: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/07/adobe-coldfusion-cve-2026-48282-exploitation-detected/>
- [4] Adobe patch context via SecurityWeek: <https://www.securityweek.com/adobe-patches-critical-coldfusion-campaign-classic-vulnerabilities/>